

The passion flower vine evolved from plants that grew at the time of the dinosaurs.

150
mya

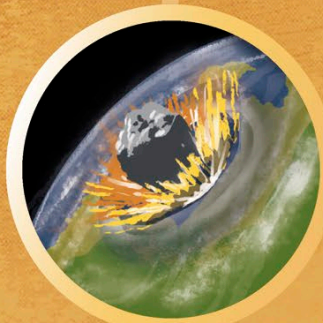
Birds

One group of dinosaurs evolved to walk on two legs and developed feathers—perhaps for display or to keep them warm. But feathery, flapping arms had other possibilities—and from walking dinosaurs came flying birds.



Archaeopteryx was a prehistoric bird with feathers and a beak—but it also had reptilian teeth and claws on its wings.

66
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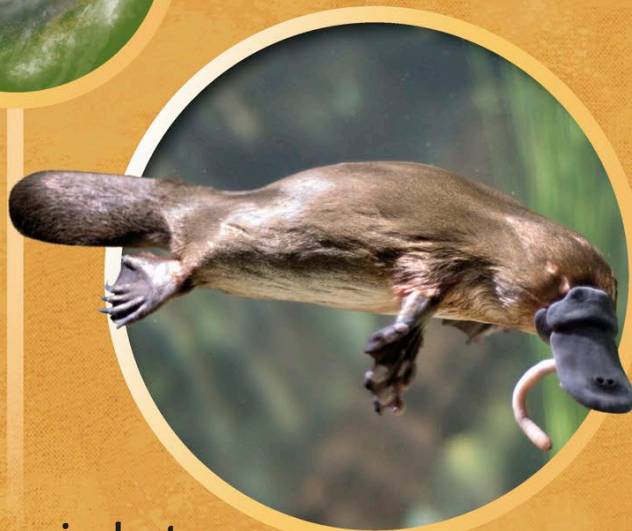


For years after impact, Earth was shrouded in a cold, dark winter.

Dinosaurs wiped out

Since life first appeared, Earth has been hit by catastrophes—such as climate change or volcanic eruptions—that wiped out entire groups. But the biggest one happened when an asteroid struck, blanketing the land with dust, and killing all dinosaurs.

60
mya



A few mammals today, such as the platypus, still lay hard-shelled eggs like their reptile ancestors.

Mammals take over

Small furry mammals were among the animals that survived the asteroid impact. When the land and climate recovered, they evolved to replace the dinosaurs as predatory meat eaters and grazing plant eaters.

13
mya

Human ancestors

One group of mammals, called primates, evolved to live in trees, with grasping hands and big brains. Some of these were expert in walking upright and became humans. Lots of humanlike primates lived in the prehistoric past, but just one species—*Homo sapiens*—lives today.



Today's humans, *Homo sapiens*, have been around for less than half a million years.

There are around 1.3 million species known on Earth today, and many more yet to be discovered.